

Inha University in Tashkent

***Theme 12.* Culture and Civilization**

Tashkent – 2024

Outline:

- The Concept of Culture and Its Historical Development
- Civilization as socio-cultural process

Culture as a Philosophical Concept

- Philosophy of culture is one of the branches of philosophy which aimed to study the essence, nature and meaning of culture.
- Cultural philosophy (german *Kulturphilosophie*) as a term was introduced in the early 19th century by the German romanticist Adam Müller (1779-1829).
- The philosophy of culture should be distinguished both from the philosophy of history and from the sociology of culture, which studies culture from the point of view of its functioning in the system of social relations.



The Definition of Culture

- The concept of culture is one of the fundamental in modern social science.
- Culture is the social behavior and norms that originate and develop in human societies.
- There are several forms of culture such as art, language, dance, music, religion, clothing and so on.
- It is difficult to name another word that would have such a multitude of semantic notion.
- The term is derived from Latin *cultura* that means "the tilling of land, cultivating, and agriculture".
- The term was first used as "cultivation through education" in the 16th century. During early of the 19th century it defined "the intellectual side of civilization" whereas from 1867 it became "collective customs and achievements of people".



The Multitude Definitions of Culture

- American cultural anthropologists Alfred Kroeber (1876-1960) and Clyde Kluckhohn in their joint study on the critical review of concepts and definitions of culture, noted the huge and growing interest in this notion.
- According to their calculations, from 1871 to 1919, only 7 definitions of culture were given (the first of which, they believe, belongs to the distinguished English ethnographer Edward Taylor).
- Then from 1920 to 1950, for various authors they counted 157 definitions of the given concept.
- In contemporary period scholars count more than 400 definitions.



The Concept of Culture

- The common understanding of the concept of culture mainly consists of three components:
 - Life values
 - Norms of behavior
 - Artifacts (material production)
- Life values denote the most important concepts in life. They are the basis of culture.
- The norms of behavior are reflected in the concept of morality. They show how people should behave in different situations.
- Rules formally fixed in the state are called Laws.
- Artifacts, or products of material culture, are usually derived from the first two components.



Culture

- Culture is not a mechanical sum of all acts of people's life.
- Culture is primarily a set of "rules of the game" of collective existence, a system of normative technologies developed by people.
- In contrast to the biological properties, cultures are not inherited genetically, and are assimilated only by the method of learning.
- Characterizing the main parameters of the culture it should also take into account that humanity, being a single biological species, has never been a single social group.
- Different populations of people live on Earth as autonomous communities in widely differing natural and historical conditions.



Definition

- Civilization (from the Latin *civilis* - civil, citizen, city, state) - one of the main units of historical time, denoting a long-existing, self-sufficient community of countries and peoples, whose origin is due to socio-cultural reasons.
- One of the first to introduce the term "civilization" into the scientific revolution was the philosopher Adam Ferguson (1723–1816), who meant by the term the stage in the development of human society, characterized by the existence of:
 - social strata,
 - cities,
 - writing and other similar phenomena.



Civilization

- The most well-known work of the scholar is “Essay on the History of the Civil Society”.
- The staged periodization of world history proposed by the Scottish scholar:
 - savagery
 - barbarity
 - civilization
- His idea enjoyed support in the scientific community at the end of the eighteenth and the beginning of the nineteenth century, but with the popularity of a plural-cyclical approach to history in the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, the notion of "civilization" increasingly meant "local civilizations".



Main definitions of civilization

- There are three main definitions of civilization:
 - 1) A synonym for culture. In Marxist literature is also used to refer to material culture.
 - 2) The level, stage of social development, material and spiritual culture (Ancient Civilization).
 - 3) The stage of social development, following barbarism (L. Morgan, F. Engels).
- Civilization is like a living organism, passing the path from birth to death, constantly reproducing itself and giving a unique identity to all the processes taking place in it.
- Following Arnold Toynbee, one can say that each civilization goes through the stages of the emergence, formation, flowering, breaking and decomposition (collapse). The word civilization is sometimes used also as a synonym for the word "culture" as mentioned above, and sometimes for the final stage of development of any culture



Early civilizations

- Early civilization period in world history starts from about 3500 BCE lasts until 1000 BCE.
- In Middle East where civilization first emerged it took about 5000 years, between the advantage of agriculture to the first arrival of civilization.
- The first specific civilization to emerge in Mesopotamia was Sumeria.
- This first civilization this prototype of early civilization generally offered a number of features that agricultural societies without civilization lacked.



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Features of Early Civilizations

❖ Characteristics:

- Large agricultural surpluses
- Formal state
- Cities
- Trade
- Writing



❖ Early Civilization areas:

- Mesopotamia
- Egypt
- India
- China



- Social collapse is the process of the collapse of complex human societies. It includes sharp social failures, such as that of the Maya civilization, as well as a longer gradual decline in the level of cultures, social institutions or civilization, as the fall of the Western Roman Empire. This process is described in anthropology, history, sociology, politics and other social fields.
- Civilizations generally ended in one of two ways:
 - by incorporating into another expanding civilization (Ancient Egypt was included in Hellenistic Greek, and then into Roman civilization)
 - by crashing and returning to a simpler form, as is the case in the so-called Dark Ages.
- Muslim philosopher of Middle Ages Ibn Khaldun in his work “Muqaddima” analyzes the growth and the cause of decline of Islamic civilization. According to his view, invasions of nomadic peoples limited development and led to social collapse.



Thank you for your attention!